

the way. Peace between Norway and Scotland was sealed later when Haakon's successor, Eric, married Margaret, Alexander's daughter.

Alexander outlived his children so when he died there was no one to succeed him but his little grand-daughter, Margaret, child of Margaret and Eric of Norway. The little Margaret sailed for Scotland, but mysteriously died in the Orkneys, on the way. With this death of the "Maid of Norway" the direct line of Alexander became extinct and the Alpine line of Scotch Kings ended at 25.

A free-for-all situation arose with about a dozen claimants to the throne. Foremost were Robert Bruce(not Robert the Bruce who came later) and John Balliol. King Edward I of England got himself appointed umpire to decide between the two, but demanded that the winner must recognize him(Edward) as Supreme Lord of Scotland; both contestants basely agreed. Balliol was chosen and for 3 years was a very subservient King. After that he made an alliance with the French and revolted; Bruce and others refused to support him. Edward invaded Scotland, slaughtered the people of Berwick-on-Tweed and decisively defeated the Scotch at Dunbar.

Edward carried away the Stone of Destiny from Scone and place it in Westminster Abbey in London, where it has remained ever since [excepting a brief time this century when Scottish nationalists kidnaped the stone and hid it]. For 9 years Edward ruled Scotland with troops garrisoned in every castle and town.

E. William Wallace. During this evil time, a Lowland Scot named Wallace arose and led a rebellion which did not succeed, but which inspired others to carry on the fight. In 1297, Wallace routed the English army of occupation at Stirling Bridge and everywhere drove the English out of Scotland. Wallace followed up by invading England and devastated the country up to Newcastle. He returned to Scotland and was elected Guardian of the country. It took Edward 2 years to raise a big enough army, but in 1298, he returned and at Falkirk defeated Wallace who took to guerilla warfare. In 1303 Edward again ravaged Scotland and in 1305 captured Wallace at Robroyston, near Glasgow. He was taken to London for trial, accused of being a robber, murderer and a traitor. Charles Dickens describes the situation:

*What they called a robber he was, because he had taken spoil from the King's men. What they called a murderer he was because he a had slain an insolent Englishmen. What they called a traitor he was not, for he had never sworn allegiance to the King and had never scorned to do it. He was dragged at the tails of horses to West Smithfield, and there hanged on high gallows, torn open before he was dead, beheaded and quartered.*

*His head was set up on a pole on London Bridge, his right arm was sent to Newcastle, his left arm to Berwick, his legs to Perth and Aberdeen. But if King Edward had had his body cut into inches, and sent every separate inch into a separate town, he could not have dispersed it half so far and wide as his fame. Wallace will be remembered in songs and stories while there are songs and stories in the English tongue, and Scotland will hold him dear while her lochs and mountains last".*

[Many Scots will recall the poem by Robert Burns, "Scots, wha hae wi Wallace bled"]. One of the noblest patriots of Scottish